

PRIORITY

If everything is urgent, nothing is urgent.

How to choose what stays out when everything is urgent.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Most of today's fire came from a decision nobody made three weeks ago.

THE CASCADE

How the whole day becomes an emergency.

WHAT YOU SEE

Everything enters the same queue, and everything enters as urgent...

THE MECHANISM

...you serve it in the order of who shouts loudest...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and what changes the result waits for tomorrow, every day.

Whoever prioritizes by noise outsources the calendar to the most anxious person.

THE FORK

Real urgency respects impact and risk.

REAL URGENCY

01

It stops today and client, money or safety suffers? Urgent.

02

The discomfort is only the requester's? That is pressure, not urgency.

03

You have decided this thirty times? Not urgency, a missing process.

Urgency with no critical impact is anxiety wearing a badge.

THE METHOD

The Fire Filter, four questions.

01 **WHAT IS BURNING?**

which result dies if nobody touches this today

02 **WHO LIT IT?**

a real fire, or one born from something you postponed

03 **WHAT DOES WAITING COST?**

half an hour, a day, a week, the cost shows up here

04 **WHO PUTS IT OUT?**

you, or whoever should already have the ceiling for it

Four questions, two minutes, and half the list leaves the stage.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

The four fires in your day.

01 • WHAT IS
BURNING?

Real fire.

threatens a client or the cash now, drop everything and put it out

02 • WHO LIT
IT?

Neglect fire.

urgent because you postponed it, put it out and kill the root

03 • WHAT DOES
WAITING COST?

The neighbor's fire.

the urgency belongs to another team, hand it back with a date

04 • WHO PUTS
IT OUT?

Stage fire.

noise and anxiety only, let it burn and stay with the plan

TWO MODELS

Prioritizing by noise or by risk.

THE COMMON MODEL

By noise

- Serves whoever pushes first
- Says yes the moment the request lands
- Measures the day by tasks closed
- Ends the week exhausted and in the same place

THE DESIGNED MODEL

By risk

- Serves what threatens the result
- Negotiates a date before accepting
- Measures the day by a decision unblocked
- Ends the week with one root fewer

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that fill your day with fire.

01 **Saying yes on the spot when the request lands.**

- with no negotiated date, every request is born due today.

02 **Being the only one who can approve.**

- your inbox becomes the official bottleneck of the operation.

03 **Making the same decision every week.**

- a repeated decision is a process nobody had time to build.

The same decision thirty times a month is not pace, it is a management failure.

THE CHAIN

The half hour test.

01

List everything that is urgent right now.



02

Ask item by item, what happens if it waits half an hour?



03

If the answer is nothing, it was pressure, not urgency.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Whatever survives the half hour test deserves your right now.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Thirty minutes to defuse the week.

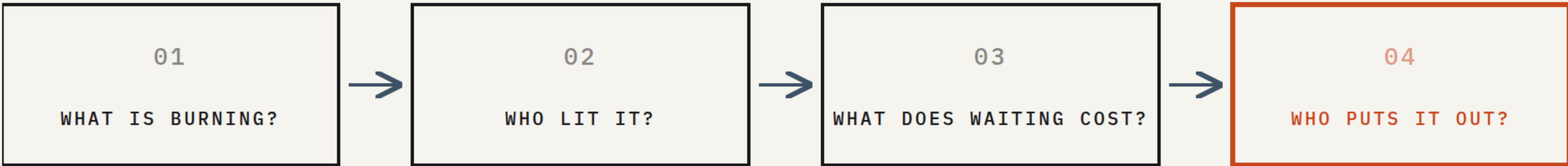
▣ STEP 01 List today's urgencies and write who lit each one. the pattern shows up by the third line, and it usually stings	▣ STEP 02 Take the most repeated urgency of the month and kill its root. half an hour outside the fire is worth weeks inside it	■ STEP 03 Agree a ceiling with the team, what they decide without you. amount, timing and type of decision, written in one line
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A priority that does not change your calendar tomorrow was discussed, not decided.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Fire Filter, in the order that matters.



Prioritizing is not choosing what to do now.
It is having the nerve to say what will not
get done today.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
next time everything turns urgent.

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